Business Expansion Assessment

Strategies and Systems to Set the Pace for Your Growth

For service businesses with $500,000+ in revenue.

SYNNOVATIA

Welcome!

My guess is you're not short on business anymore. You're short on bandwidth. Work is coming in, but you're still in the middle of every decision, good people are walking out the door faster than you'd like, and you can feel service start to slip whenever volume climbs.

That's the real work of this stage: the systems and strategy that got you here haven't caught up to the business you've already built. Growth keeps asking for a new version of the business, and most owners are figuring that out without anyone telling them it's normal.

I can assure you this assessment will show you exactly where the gap is. I've watched owners go through it and come out the other side with a clear read on what to fix first, not a vague sense that operations need work, but the actual system or decision that's costing them the most.

Whether it's your team, your cash flow, or the sheer number of decisions still landing on your desk, the Business Expansion Assessment shows you which of those is the real bottleneck.

Once you complete the assessment, you'll have a clear picture of where your systems are solid enough to carry more weight, and where they're not. You'll also know exactly which areas you can set aside for now.

Caution: It's important to view this as a snapshot, not a verdict. Don't be discouraged if your score isn't what you expect. Your score is neither good nor bad. It just shows you where to focus next.

It just shows you where to focus, and how to use this assessment.

How to Use This Assessment

Predictable growth is still built through a regular practice of analyze → plan → execute → evaluate. The difference at this stage is how many more moving pieces you're tracking at once. To get the most from this assessment, treat it as a recurring check, not a one-time test.

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Instructions

1. Read each statement in each section.
Each of the 10 core business sections includes only the statements most relevant to Stage II: 50 in total, ranging from two statements in some sections to ten in others. Shorter sections share a page with a neighboring section; that's intentional, not a mistake. Read each statement carefully and check the box if the statement is CONSISTENTLY TRUE for you. Leave the box blank until you have done what is necessary to make it consistently true.

2. Count the number of true statements in each section.
Compile the number of checked boxes of each of the 10 sections on the Progress Chart. Total your score (each statement is worth 1 point).

3. Review your results.
Which areas are strongest? Which ones need attention? Did anything surprise you? We'll get into this at the end of this assessment, including how to evaluate your results and prioritize the area(s) of focus.

One more thing . . .

Like most things in business and life, you get out of this what you put into it. To ensure you get the most from this assessment, I have two recommendations:

1. Go deep.
Get into the data of your business. For the consistently true statements, do you have proof to back up your answer? Are there testimonials that show you're doing it right? Take the time to dig in and get the real picture. The deeper you go, the more this assessment helps you make strategic choices to move your business forward.

2. Review this assessment with a trusted business coach or advisor.
It's hard to be objective about your own business when you're this close to it. An outside, unbiased perspective keeps you honest about what you see. If you'd like to walk through your results together, book time directly on my calendar. (Your first call is on me.)

Find a Time That Works

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Business Expansion Assessment

Business Foundation Development

At this stage, your growth strategy is the real foundation question: does it still give you a competitive edge, or is it running on momentum from an earlier version of the business?

- ☐ I have upgraded my growth strategy to produce a competitive advantage and direct my decisions.
- ☐ I have the proper insurance coverage in place to protect my business, such as key person insurance, disability insurance, etc.
- ☐ Key business variables influencing future growth are identified and monitored regularly.
- ☐ My business could operate for 30 days without my direct involvement.

TOTAL (out of 4): 0

Product and Service Development

Products and services are the lifeblood of an organization. Your business must be good at finding and growing successful products and services to obtain sustainable growth.

- ☐ I have a development process for finding and growing new products and services.
- ☐ I know what I must do to move my product and service to the next stage.
- ☐ I regularly re-evaluate my pricing to make sure it reflects the value I deliver as the business grows and allows for a sustainable profit margin.

TOTAL (out of 3): 0

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Marketing and Branding Strategies

Your brand used to travel through you personally. At this stage it reaches more touch points than you can be present for, so consistency has to come from a system, not just your instincts. Evaluating which marketing efforts actually produce a return keeps that expansion honest.

- ☐ I regularly evaluate the effectiveness of my marketing efforts to determine which methods provide the greatest rate of return.
- ☐ I manage the touch points of customer contact (i.e., personal interactions, telephone interactions, web site, word of mouth, etc.) to ascertain a consistent brand experience.
- ☐ I know what makes my organization different than my competitors and clearly articulate it in all of my marketing efforts.

TOTAL (out of 3): 0

Accounting and Financial Growth

Following sound accounting procedures and a precise budget are critical to ensuring funds are accurately flowing in and out of your business to meet financial expectations and sustain profitability.

- ☐ The essential and suitable finances are in place to grow and develop my business.
- ☐ Accounts payable is consistently handled in a professional, timely manner.
- ☐ Written accounts receivable policies and procedures support business growth and are clearly conveyed to my customers.
- ☐ A reliable bookkeeping system provides financial data that allows for an accurate business analysis at any point in time.
- ☐ I meet regularly with my financial team to understand the current state of my organization's finances.
- ☐ I have adequate cash reserves or access to capital to weather unexpected shortfalls.
- ☐ I make profit everyone's responsibility.
- ☐ A tracking system allows for effective cash management and accounting information to facilitate growth.

TOTAL (out of 8): 0

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Sales Tools and Growth

Selling isn't a one-person job anymore. Once you have a sales force to support and projections to plan around, your tools have to work for a team, not just for you.

- ☐ Accurate sales projections are in place for the next six to twelve months.
- ☐ My sales force is compensated and supported adequately.
- ☐ I have a documented sales process that delivers results and is followed consistently.

TOTAL (out of 3): 0

Serving Clients and Generating Referrals

Regular engagement allows you to better serve your clients by anticipating their needs. Serving your clients and assisting in their success leads to customer retention and the opportunity for referrals.

- ☐ I have established benchmarks for serving clients in my industry.
- ☐ I have an objective system for quantifying customer engagement and fulfillment.
- ☐ Standards for serving my clients are written.
- ☐ Quarterly meetings are held with key customers and client-suggested improvements are implemented.
- ☐ No single client or small group of clients accounts for an outsized share of my revenue.

TOTAL (out of 5): 0

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Operational System Development

Operational systems are the glue that holds your business together. Smooth operating systems keep your business performing—even when you, the owner, are absent.

- [ ] My systems are designed to avoid redundancy in effort.
- [ ] My operational systems have more capacity than is currently needed allowing me to grow without struggling.
- [ ] An organizational chart is in place that fosters free-flowing communication preventing duplication of effort.
- [ ] I have a written disaster plan that is reviewed regularly to prevent delays in product and service in the event of a calamity (i.e., hurricane, system crash, fire, etc.).
- [ ] My technology systems and data are protected against cybersecurity risks.
- [ ] I re-evaluate my software subscriptions annually to confirm they still deliver value.
- [ ] My infrastructure can support the business I have today and the one I'm building for tomorrow.
- [ ] My core legal documents, such as contracts, employee handbooks, and intellectual property protections, are kept current as my business grows.

TOTAL (out of 8): 0

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Personnel and Vendor Development

An investment in the skills, knowledge, and experience of your staff is as important as your infrastructure investment. Select your vendors carefully to ensure they are equally committed to the high standards you place upon yourself and your business.

- ☐ All personnel and vendors have been educated in the proven, effective way I do business.
- ☐ Position descriptions and performance expectations are clearly written and communicated. Everyone fully understands their goals as proven by their performance.
- ☐ I don't tolerate poor vendor and/or personnel performance.
- ☐ Daily goals and objectives inspire and make the best use of everyone's strengths rather than merely provide a to-do list.
- ☐ I take a team approach with my vendors, actively engaging them in my business growth by meeting with them quarterly.
- ☐ I know the qualities, skills, and strengths needed by my staff and vendors and do not hire below those standards.
- ☐ Key result areas have been identified for each position in the business.
- ☐ I have a management layer in place that can make key decisions without me.
- ☐ I have a repeatable hiring and onboarding process for bringing on new team members.
- ☐ I have a plan for retaining key employees that goes beyond compensation.

TOTAL (out of 10): 0

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Business Skill Growth

Mastering your craft is simply the first step for sustainable business growth. Developing your business skills strengthens your chance for success.

- [ ] I am comfortable and confident in resolving conflict and building consensus with clients, vendors, and/or personnel.
- [ ] My dedication to lifelong learning serves as an example for others on my team.
- [ ] I continually keep the business in good enough shape to sell.
- [ ] I do what I do best and effectively delegate the rest.

TOTAL (out of 4): 0

Entrepreneur Performance and Foundation

The quality of your performance as an entrepreneur and the success of your business are dependent upon your physical and mental wellness.

- [ ] I am achievement (to grow) focused rather than accomplishment (to-do) oriented.
- [ ] I have a reserve of resources (i.e., time, money, space, skills, staff, and opportunities).

TOTAL (out of 2): 0

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Progress Chart

	Business Foundation (of 4)	Product and Service (of 3)	Marketing and Branding (of 3)	Accounting and Financial (of 8)	Sales Tools and Growth (of 3)	Serve Client and Referrals (of 5)	Operational System (of 8)	Personnel and Vendor (of 10)	Business Skill (of 4)	Entrepreneur Performance (of 2)
Totals	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

TOTAL SCORE (out of 50) 0

Date	Score	+/- Points

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Turn Your Score into Action

The number itself matters less than what you do with it. A few sections are probably already solid. One or two are likely the reason growth still feels harder than it should.

Here's how to turn today's score into real movement.

1. Look at the whole board.
Walk your Progress Chart section by section. Which areas are already carrying their weight? Which ones are barely holding?

2. Pick one area. Just one.
As author Gary Keller is fond of saying "What's the ONE Thing you can do such that by doing it everything else will be easier or unnecessary?" That's the thing you want to select. Working every area at once is how expansion stalls out instead of speeding up. Your Progress Chart totals are the fastest way to see which one needs it most.

3. Build a 90-day plan, not a wish list.
Set one specific, measurable target for the area you picked. Work backward from it: what has to be true in 30 days? In 60? Build the plan around actions, not intentions.

4. Reassess on a real cadence.
Growth moves fast at this stage. Put this assessment back on your calendar every 90 days, and treat the score as a trend, not a single grade.

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